

Database Attributes

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Definition

An attribute is a property or characteristic that describes an entity or a relationship.

Characteristics of Attributes

Every attribute has:

- A name
- A value
- A domain (allowed values)
- A data type (during implementation)

Attribute Classifications

Simple Attribute

A Simple Attribute (Atomic Attribute) cannot be divided into smaller meaningful parts.

Composite Attribute

A Composite Attribute can be divided into smaller meaningful attributes.

Single-valued Attribute

An attribute that has only one value for each entity.

Multivalued Attribute

An attribute that can have multiple values for one entity.

Derived Attribute

A Derived Attribute is calculated from another attribute.
It is usually not stored because it can be computed when needed.

Key Attribute

A Key Attribute uniquely identifies every entity.

Null Attribute

A Null Attribute is an attribute whose value is unknown, unavailable, or not applicable.